

Chris Tham

Strategy Consultant | Technology Strategy, Architecture and Business Change

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PROFILE

Founder of Hello Tham, a boutique strategy consulting company. Available for short to medium term consulting engagements spanning strategic business change, business and operating model design, business process improvement, and technology strategy, architecture and solutions.

My career has now spanned four decades and I am looking forward to entering the fifth:

- In the first decade I started as an analyst for a fintech, and then a financial institution. I pivoted to be a systems and architecture consultant for two of the biggest computer companies in the world: AT&T/NCR and HP.
- In the second decade I pivoted back to Banking and Finance. I established and managed successful strategy and architecture functions in several institutions including MLC, NAB and ING.
- In the third decade I transitioned to become a strategy consultant and have delivered successful engagements to Transfield Services, Broadspectrum and Transport for NSW.
- In the fourth decade I am working on things that interest and matter to me. I teach at Torrens University, and have continued my consulting career. I have also written a book, AI-dō.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Flexible strategic change agent and thought leader** — I have facilitated business and technology strategic change for three decades – from Head of Strategy positions at MLC, NAB and ING to delivering IT strategies, roadmaps and operating models as a consultant to Transfield Services and Transport for NSW (through my consulting company Hello Tham).
- **Successful and proven technology strategy and architecture leader** — I have built successful architecture practices at organisations from MLC (where I wrote my own job description and built a practice that became a case study at international conferences) to NAB, ING and Broadspectrum. I have provided enterprise architecture advice as a consultant to Transport for NSW and currently at Cochlear.
- **Recognised technology innovator and industry expert** — I have been involved in new technologies for my entire career, from early beginnings managing one of Australia's first commercial UNIX systems at Bain & Co, which I connected to ACSnet in 1986 to make it one of the earliest non-academic organisations in the country online, to a patented service-oriented advice platform my team pioneered at MLC, to using a large language model to classify support calls in 2018, long before ChatGPT. Most recently I shaped Cochlear's AI strategy. I teach Information Systems at Torrens University, and have written AI-dō, a book on using AI effectively.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Enterprise Architect (Consulting)

2025 – Present

Cochlear

- Enterprise architecture within Technology & Data Solutions, improving enterprise coherence across federated business domains while enabling faster, safer delivery through reusable architecture services, live architecture repositories, governed AI patterns and measurable architecture value.
- Developed enterprise architecture service models, reusable architecture deliverables and assurance practices across advisory, planning and solution architecture services.
- Designed the EA metrics framework and LeanIX-based executive reporting approach to measure architecture value, repository health, strategic alignment, technology risk, technical debt and governance effectiveness.
- Shaped the AI architecture strategy and AI Reference Architecture, defining federated AI ecosystem patterns, enterprise AI principles, agentic AI guardrails and deployment options aligned to governance, privacy, security and interoperability needs.
- Created enterprise guidelines for WalkMe as the Digital Adoption Platform, defining governance, privacy, identity, content ownership and federated operating model controls for internal enterprise applications.
- Embedded LeanIX into the federated architecture governance model, shifting practice from static document reviews to live fact-sheet-driven governance, metrics, decision evidence and portfolio transparency.

Architecture practice

- Defined an architecture service catalogue spanning strategic consulting, business and technology roadmaps, enterprise guidelines, proposal assessment, solution architecture, options analysis and architecture assurance.
- Established reusable deliverables including strategic architecture roadmaps, capability maturity assessments, reference architecture libraries, solution architecture blueprints, integration design specifications, decision support matrices and assurance reports.

Architecture metrics

- Mapped metrics to strategic priorities and executive reporting: repository completeness, strategic initiative coverage, application rationalisation, technology obsolescence risk, technical debt remediation, federated decision ratio, decision velocity, assurance coverage and stakeholder satisfaction.
- Defined a phased dashboard roadmap taking cumulative coverage from 6 of 19 metrics to 13, then to all 19, with increasing integration across Jira, HR, Finance, ADR and survey processes.

AI architecture

- Produced an AI Reference Architecture of modular building blocks, principles, patterns, guardrails and guidelines, balancing enterprise coherence with domain agility across multiple deployment options.
- Established an AI pattern taxonomy spanning foundational, contextual and agentic patterns, from AI model access and AI-native DevOps through to personal agents, agentic process automation and external-facing agents.
- Defined architecture controls for agentic AI including unique agent identity, least privilege, lifecycle controls, data and model governance, monitoring and observability, human oversight and audit evidence, aligned to ISO/IEC 42001 and ISO/IEC 23894.

Digital adoption

- Positioned WalkMe as a governed enterprise platform to accelerate adoption of growth-enabling systems such as Salesforce and SAP, with guardrails covering business process ownership of content, certified content builders, SailPoint integration, SSO alignment, Privacy Impact Assessment requirements and PII masking.

Learning Facilitator (Lecturer)

2024 – Present

Torrens University Australia

- Lecturer in Information Systems in the School of Business, teaching undergraduate and masters students.
- Awarded the Learning and Teaching Merit Award twice, with perfect student satisfaction scores in end-of-trimester student evaluation surveys.

Undergraduate subjects

- **MIS100 Foundations of Information Systems** — how organisations use information systems strategically to solve problems, make decisions and stay competitive, spanning hardware, software, data and emerging technologies, alongside artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, privacy and professional ethics.
- **MIS300 Systems Analysis and Design** — the techniques a systems analyst uses to design information systems that advance organisational goals: analysing and defining requirements, modelling process and data, and transforming user requirements into system design using UML, with an emphasis on user centrality.
- **IND201A Industry Engagement Project** — a work-integrated consultancy project run with external clients through the university's Social Enterprise Hub, building employability skills and team contribution to social and business outcomes, and carrying 100 hours of credit towards industry practicum requirements.

Postgraduate subjects

- **MIS610 Advanced Professional Practice** — industry-led preparation for careers in information systems: professional roles and ethics in a global context, culture, governance, and legal and compliance obligations including GDPR, alongside aligning strategy and change management to business priorities and communicating with technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- **MIS611 Information Systems Capstone** — a work-integrated capstone in which student teams deliver a prototype solution for a client organisation, working through the Stanford design thinking cycle from discovery and empathy mapping to ideation, prototyping and testing, and communicating progress and outcomes to stakeholders and non-specialists.

Principal Consultant and Junior Janitor

2016 – Present

Hello Tham

- Founder and Junior Janitor of a boutique consultancy spanning business and IT strategy, enterprise architecture, operating models, strategic roadmaps, analytics and data science, digital products and content platforms.
- Author of **AI-dō: The Way of AI**, and developer of **FinvestLens** and **HelloNotes**, two native Apple applications published as free software.
- Successfully delivered multiple consulting engagements, including Cochlear, Transport for NSW and Broadspectrum.

Writing

- **AI-dō: The Way of AI, grounded in practice** — a book on working with artificial intelligence in a disciplined, human-centred way. Free to read online, with PDF and ePub editions.

Applications

- **FinvestLens** — native double-entry accounting for macOS, iPadOS and iOS, built on the rigour of the GnuCash engine. Keeps accounts in local documents, imports multiple formats and generates professional reports. Released as free software under GPLv3.
- **HelloNotes** — a private, local-first Markdown knowledge base for macOS, with wiki-links, backlinks, a graph view, full-text search and on-device intelligence. Works on plain files you control, with no accounts and no tracking.

Website

- Designed and built hellotham.com, the firm's site and publishing platform for the book and applications, now in its fifth major iteration.

Principal Consultant (Consulting)

2016 – 2019

Transport for NSW

- Developed the financial model and engaged Finance stakeholders for the business case for a multi-year investment programme covering a suite of enterprise applications.
- Led proofs of concept: a native iOS app in Swift authenticating via Azure AD against the Microsoft Graph API, a JavaScript front end embedded in a ServiceNow portal over a back-end SAP OData service, and a vendor-sponsored chatbot servicing leave requests.
- Built management KPI dashboards in Tableau and custom SQL, and applied text-analysis machine learning with fast.ai and AWS SageMaker to predict the correct resolver group for IT incidents.
- Mentored senior employees and participated in the Women in IT Leadership group.

Strategy Consultant / Executive Manager (Consulting)

2011 – 2016

Broadspectrum

- Facilitated and co-developed the IT strategy, its roadmap and the input to the Board paper, leading the “Flexible Edges” and “Analytics” themes — Tableau and AWS Redshift analytics, and IoT sensor monitoring.
- Interim Executive Manager, Architecture and Design: reviewed the position, defined SAP strategy and technical relationship management, assisted in recruiting the permanent appointment, and set the FY2015–18 architecture initiatives.
- Established a data analytics capability in operations and business development, evaluated field service management mobility solutions, and developed a strategic technology architecture and migration roadmap.
- Contributed Section 13.2 of APQC's global Process Classification Framework; the underlying standardisation across a group of more than 26,000 people was published by APQC as a case study reporting a 30 per cent reduction in process redundancy.

Consultant (Consulting), Thorogood & Associates

2011

Developed social media workshop material and consulted on the business case for an online campus and a Western Sydney campus for the University of New England.

Head of Strategy and Architecture, ING Australia

2008

Established the IT Strategy and Architecture function of around twenty people, its governance and roadmaps.

Head of Architecture / Strategy Consultant

2005 – 2007

NAB Group

- Head of Architecture, Distribution (2005): created a new architecture function for a business unit covering every distribution channel, delivered a sales, servicing and channels business architecture, and led the architecture stream of the Australian region technology strategy.
- Head of Architecture, Retail Banking (2006): doubled the team and introduced a new operating model, delivering target architectures for document production, imaging and workflow, and electronic forms.
- Strategy Consultant (2007): input to the Integrated Platform strategy consolidating technology and vendor diversity, strategy and architecture for the Corporate Centre functions, and the Australian region business process model.

Head of Strategy and Architecture

1998 – 2004

MLC

- Established the architecture function, re-establishing strategic control over a fully outsourced IT operation; its governance processes and its solution architecture role were both later adopted as standards across NAB.

- Led MLC's IT strategy in 1999 and its application architecture stream in 2001, oversaw the introduction of AdviserCentral, Compass, Masterkey and Siebel, and helped define the Enterprise Medium Term Vision and business case for the \$200m Amazon Programme.

Architecture Consultant, Hewlett Packard 1995 – 1998
Consulted to organisations including Boral on technology infrastructure strategy, server upgrades and data centre consolidation.

Architecture Consultant, AT&T Global Information Solutions (NCR) 1992 – 1995
Consulted to organisations including St. George Bank, Franklins, Rockmans and Telstra.

Treasury Analyst, State Bank Victoria 1990 – 1991
Pricing exotic options as a Treasury analyst, and maintaining the Treasury management system.

Systems Analyst, Optech International 1988 – 1989
Option pricing and distributed risk management for Tesla, a foreign exchange options trading system built at Optech.

Tutor and Programmer, University of Sydney 1984 – 1988
Casual tutor in the Basser Department of Computer Science, and earlier a programmer for the Department of Chemistry.

Casual Staff, Bain & Company 1986 – 1987
Administered one of Australia's first commercial UNIX systems, and in 1986 connected the firm to ACSnet, making it one of the earliest non-academic organisations in the country online.

Software Engineer, Rational Research 1985
Door access and lift security control programs, and a diagnostic interface and machine language monitor for an in-house embedded operating system.

EDUCATION

Master of Applied Finance 1992 – 1994
Macquarie University

- Awarded the Australian Institute of Bankers Prize for Management of Financial Institutions.
- Awarded the Australian Institute of Bankers "The Institute Prize", for graduating top of the class.

Graduate Diploma 1990 – 1992
Securities Institute of Australia

- Graduate Diploma in Applied Finance and Investment, with a High Distinction in Foreign Exchange.

Bachelor of Science (1st Class Honours and University Medal) 1984 – 1988
University of Sydney

- Honours thesis **Rubato**, a language for writing music down that reads like music rather than like code, coupled to a system that performs it. Graded First Class with the University Medal.
- Held the E. Trenchard Miller Memorial Scholarship from 1984 to 1987, and was awarded a University Postgraduate Research Award upon graduation.

New South Wales Higher School Certificate 1983
Randwick High School

- Aggregate mark of 488 out of 500, ranked in the top 1% of New South Wales.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Autonomy	● ● ● ● ● ○	Problem-solving	● ● ● ● ● ○
Complexity	● ● ● ● ● ○	Adaptability	● ● ● ● ● ○
Creativity	● ● ● ● ● ○	Communication	● ● ● ● ● ○
Improvement mindset	● ● ● ● ● ○	Decision-making	● ● ● ● ● ○
Influence	● ● ● ● ● ○	Digital mindset	● ● ● ● ● ○
Learning and development	● ● ● ● ● ○	Knowledge	● ● ● ● ● ○